

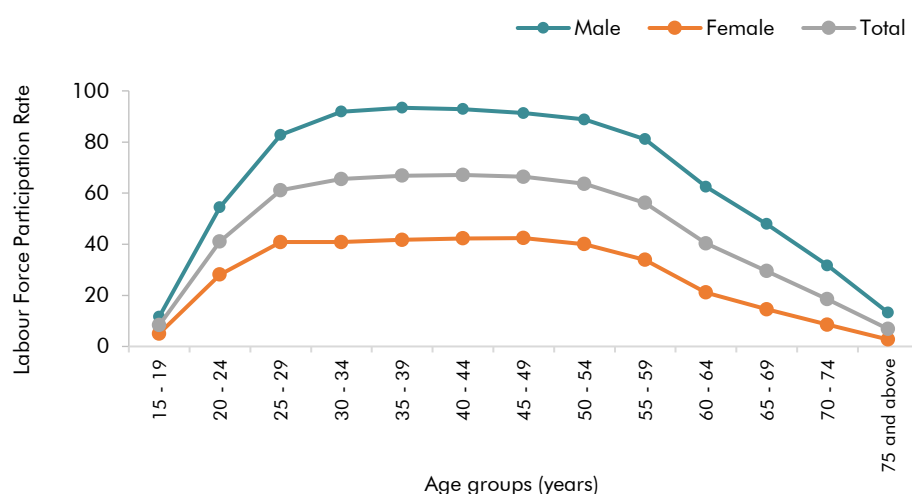
## 8.5 Labour Force Participation Rate

The proportion of the economically active population to the total working-age population is defined as the Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR). This rate indicates the number of individuals, out of every 100 persons aged 15 and over, who are either employed or unemployed but actively seeking and available for work. In other words, it provides an indication of the size of the population that contributes, or is willing and prepared to contribute, labour to the economy.

**Table 8.4 : Labour Force Participation Rate by Age Group and Sex, 2024**

| Age Group<br>(Years) | Labour Force Participation Rate |      |        |
|----------------------|---------------------------------|------|--------|
|                      | Total                           | Male | Female |
| Aged 15 & over       | 47.3                            | 67.4 | 28.9   |
| 15 - 19              | 8.3                             | 11.6 | 5.0    |
| 20 - 24              | 41.1                            | 54.5 | 28.1   |
| 25 - 29              | 61.1                            | 82.8 | 40.8   |
| 30 - 34              | 65.5                            | 91.9 | 40.8   |
| 35 - 39              | 66.8                            | 93.4 | 41.7   |
| 40 - 44              | 67.1                            | 92.9 | 42.3   |
| 45 - 49              | 66.4                            | 91.3 | 42.4   |
| 50 - 54              | 63.6                            | 88.8 | 40.0   |
| 55 - 59              | 56.2                            | 81.1 | 33.9   |
| 60 - 64              | 40.3                            | 62.5 | 21.1   |
| 65 - 69              | 29.5                            | 47.9 | 14.5   |
| 70 - 74              | 18.5                            | 31.7 | 8.5    |
| 75 and over          | 6.8                             | 13.2 | 2.7    |

According to Table 8.4, the labour force participation rate (LFPR) in Sri Lanka during the reference period was reported as 47.3 percent. The labour force participation rate for males was 67.4 percent, while the corresponding rate for females was 28.9 percent. However, when the data are considered separately by age group and sex, different values are observed. A notable feature is that the labour force participation rate for males is higher than that for females across all age groups. This distribution is clearly depicted in Figure 8.5.



**Figure 8.5 : Labour Force Participation Rate by Age Group and Sex, 2024**